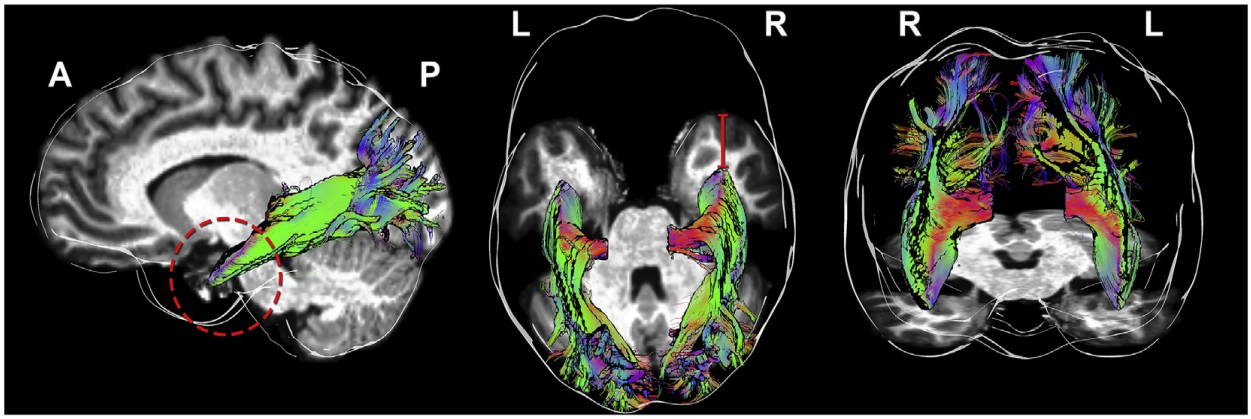


PSYC100 L: Introduction to Psychology

Fall 2027

Instructor

Jordan Lopez, M.D., Ph.D.
Professor of Psychology, Biological Sciences, Neurobiology & Biomedical Engineering
jlopez@usc.edu
Office: Auditory Neuroscience Institute, Suite 500 (5th floor)
Office Hours: T/TH 11am & 7pm

Course Times & Locations

Component	Days & Times	Location
Lecture	Mon / Wed / Fri, 1:00 to 2:50 PM	NEU 500
Laboratory	Lab sections (begin Week 1): Tue 10am – 12:50pm Tue 1pm – 3:50pm Wed 9am – 11:50am Thu 10am – 12:50pm Thu 4pm – 6:50pm	 NEU LAB1A NEU LAB1A NEU LAB1A NEU LAB1A NEU LAB1A
Exams (4 total)	**Exams taken in Quiz Section Mondays at 5:00 PM Sep 20, Oct 18, Nov 8; Exam 4: Dec 8–15	NEU 100A or NEU 100B

Course Description

Psychology is the scientific study of mind and behavior. PSYC100 L introduces the biological, cognitive, developmental, and social processes that shape human experience. Topics include sensation and perception, consciousness, learning and memory, language and decision-making, intelligence, motivation and emotion, development across the lifespan, personality, social behavior, psychological disorders, and treatment. Psychological concepts are examined through the experiments and observations that established them and the questions that continue to guide research.

The course emphasizes how psychological theories are developed, tested, and revised. Foundational experiments and contemporary research provide a framework for examining relationships among brain function, cognition, behavior, and the social and cultural environment. Students evaluate experimental designs, interpret behavioral data, distinguish causal evidence from correlation, and consider how sampling, measurement, and reproducibility affect scientific conclusions. Across topics, the goal is to explain psychological processes and assess the evidence supporting competing explanations.

This is the only PSYC100 offering that includes experimental laboratory sections in place of discussion sections. Laboratories begin in the first week and meet in their own scheduled sections, outside lecture hours. Students conduct behavioral experiments, formulate testable predictions, analyze data, and communicate findings in scientific reports. Lecture and laboratory together connect core psychological concepts with the methods used to investigate them, preparing students to evaluate psychological claims and pursue further study in psychology and related fields.

Prerequisites

Basic-level statistics is required for this offering of PSYC100. Students must satisfy the statistics prerequisite or receive a waiver before registering; students who have neither satisfied the prerequisite nor received a waiver will be unable to register. An approved equivalent may be recognized automatically, or the prerequisite may be waived automatically during course registration. Contact the instructor with questions about eligibility or to request consideration of a waiver. Students accessing this syllabus are presumed to have satisfied the statistics prerequisite or received an approved waiver. No previous psychology, neuroscience, programming, or advanced statistics knowledge is assumed; course-specific methods and analyses are introduced in lecture and laboratory.

Course Materials

Required textbook: Myers, D. G., DeWall, C. N., and Gruber, J. Psychology (14th ed.). Worth / Macmillan Learning.

Assigned textbook readings and research articles are required course preparation. The textbook builds the conceptual foundation for lecture, while research articles allow us to examine specific experiments, current findings, and emerging questions. Lectures build on these readings and often extend beyond the textbook.

Lecture slides are the primary source of instruction, and exams are based on lecture content. Use the assigned readings to develop context, clarify unfamiliar concepts, and deepen your understanding of the evidence discussed in class. Slides provide a framework for lecture but they do not capture every explanation, example, or discussion that may appear on an exam.

Although this is an introductory course, it moves quickly and asks you to do more than memorize terminology. We cover substantial material and regularly work through experiments and data. No previous psychology background is expected, but consistent preparation is essential: complete assigned readings, attend lecture, review your notes regularly, and seek

help early when something is unclear. The textbook, research articles, lectures, and labs are intended to support one another as you build these skills.

Required equipment: a laptop with a current browser and access to a spreadsheet or a free graphical analysis tool such as jamovi, plus a reliable connection to the course site. Contact the instructor or TA if equipment or accessibility is a concern. No paid courseware or access code is required for the laboratory activities.

Course Objectives

- Explain fundamental concepts across biological, cognitive, developmental, social, personality, and clinical psychology.
- Describe how experiments test explanations of perception, learning, memory, motivation, development, and behavior.
- Evaluate psychological evidence, interpret figures and results, and distinguish causation, correlation, and uncertainty.
- Compare foundational and contemporary findings, including how culture, sampling, and context affect generalization.
- Conduct a structured laboratory task, analyze authentic data, and communicate a defensible scientific conclusion.

Teaching Assistants

This course has no co-instructor. Questions about lab logistics, lab reports, and assignment expectations should go to your assigned TA first. Concerns about scores or grading feedback, including requests for regrading, should be sent directly to me at jlopez@usc.edu.

Role	Name	Email	Office Hours / Location
Lab TA (Section T/W)	Samuel Hires	hires@usc.edu	Mon, Fri; 4pm @ANI500A
Lab TA (Section TH)	David Mckemy	dkemy@usc.edu	Tues, Wed, Thurs; 3pm @ANI500A
Exam Proctor	Sarah W Bottjer	sbottjer@usc.edu	ANI 402

Grading

This course has two components, lecture and laboratory. Each is scored out of 100 percent. Your final grade is 50 percent lecture and 50 percent laboratory. **You must earn at least 60 percent in BOTH components to pass the course.** A strong lecture score does not rescue a failing lab score, and the reverse is also true.

Lecture Component (100%)

Assessment	Weight of Lecture Grade	Points
Exam 1 (Lectures 1 to 10)	20%	120
Exam 2 (Lectures 11 to 20)	20%	120
Exam 3 (Lectures 21 to 30)	20%	120
Exam 4 (Lectures 31 to 41)	20%	120
Lecture Project (data analysis or APA paper)	20%	120
Total	100%	600

Laboratory Component (100%)

Assessment	Weight of Lab Grade
Lab Reports (8 counted of 10, 7.5% each)	60%
Individual Experimental Practical	10%
Methods Assignments (3 at 5% each)	15%
Mini-Replication Project	15%
Total	100%

Dr. J's Grading Philosophy and Curve

Psychology requires you to explain behavior, interpret experimental evidence, and compare competing explanations. This is an introductory course, so unfamiliar terms, methods, and analyses are introduced step by step. Memorizing terminology alone is not sufficient; you must be able to explain a concept, describe what an experiment tested, and apply your understanding to unfamiliar results.

Exams and laboratory assignments reflect these expectations. Some assessments will be difficult, and raw percentages may be lower than you are accustomed to. Grades reflect demonstrated understanding, scientific accuracy, and the quality of your reasoning. Consistent effort and participation are important, but they do not substitute for meeting the course's academic standards.

If the final class average, calculated using the weighted lecture and laboratory grades before curving, is below 70%, a curve will be applied at the end of the course. If the class average is 70% or higher, no curve will be applied. The size of any adjustment will depend on overall class performance. A curve accounts for assessment difficulty while maintaining expectations for mastery; it does not guarantee a particular letter grade or a passing grade. Use early assessment results to identify gaps in your understanding, review feedback, and seek help promptly. Do not rely on a possible curve to compensate for missing work or consistently weak performance. You must still earn at least 60% in both the lecture and laboratory components to pass the course.

Grading Scale After Curving (changes year to year)

The percentage ranges below are approximate estimates, not fixed or guaranteed cutoffs. The grading scale may change from year to year, and final cutoffs for this semester may differ

based on overall class performance and any curve applied under the policy above. Use this table as a general guide when estimating your grade.

Letter Grade	Approximate Percentage Range
A	90-100%
A-	85-89.9%
B+	80-84.9%
B	75-79.9%
B-	70-74.9%
C+	65-69.9%
C	60-64.9%
C-	55-59.9%
D	45-54.9%
F	Below 45%

Final grades are not rounded up. Letter grades will be assigned strictly according to the finalized cutoffs, which will be announced before final grades are assigned. Regardless of any adjustment to the scale, you must earn at least 60% in both the lecture and laboratory components to pass the course.

Exams

There are four exams, each worth 120 points. Exam 1 covers Lectures 1 to 10, Exam 2 covers Lectures 11 to 20, Exam 3 covers Lectures 21 to 30, and Exam 4 covers Lectures 31 to 41. Exams are not cumulative, but the concepts build on one another. Planned dates are Monday, September 20; Monday, October 18; and Monday, November 8. Exam 4 will use the assigned university appointment within December 8–15. All exams use the separate exam session. Exams 1–3 meet Mondays at 5:00 PM in NEU 100A or NEU 100B. Exam 4's assigned date and time will be announced separately. Dates and room reservations remain subject to departmental confirmation.

- **Number of questions and versions:** Expect 65 questions totaling 120 points: 10 multiple-choice questions at 1 point each, 10 fill-in-the-blank questions at 1 point each, 35 short written-response questions at 2 points each, and 10 extended written-response or data-interpretation questions at 3 points each. Written-response questions account for 45 of the 65 questions and 100 of the 120 points. The final timing will be checked against the assigned exam-session length. Each exam comes in three versions (V1, V2, and V3). The three versions contain the same questions, with the order of questions and answer choices mixed within each lecture section.
- **Question order:** Exam questions are ordered by lecture. Questions on Lecture 1 come first, followed by questions on Lecture 2, and so on through the last lecture covered by that exam.

- **Room and version assignment:** Before each exam, a randomized algorithm assigns every student to Room A (NEU 100A) or Room B (NEU 100B) and to one of three versions (V1, V2, or V3). Assignments are posted on the course site before the exam. Assignments are random, and requests to change them will not be accepted. Approved accommodations are implemented through the university process.

- **Exam format:** In-person paper exams consisting primarily of written free-response and fill-in-the-blank questions, with a smaller number of multiple-choice questions. Questions may require definitions in context, explanations of findings, interpretation of figures and data, or evaluation of an experimental design. Approximately 40% of points address concepts directly and 60% address studies or experimental reasoning.
- **Expectations for answers:** Draw directly from lecture content, explain specific experiments and findings, and identify the evidence supporting your answer. Use relevant examples of psychological processes and behavior. Memorizing terminology or repeating slide text without demonstrating understanding is not sufficient.
- **Missed exams:** Make-up exams are not given. If you miss one exam, a zero will initially be recorded. If the absence is approved for a valid, documented medical or official reason, that zero will be replaced at the end of the semester by the average of your other three exam scores. This replacement uses your other exam scores, not your final course grade. An undocumented or unapproved absence will remain a zero. Approved accommodations, religious observance, and university-required alternatives take precedence.
- Bring a photo ID and a pencil (YOU WILL BE VERIFIED). Phones, smartwatches, and notes are not allowed
- **Exams are closed-note** unless the class negotiates an alternative at the beginning of the semester (and/or before Exam I). The class may negotiate permission to bring **one 8.5 × 11-inch handwritten reference sheet (double sided, OK). In exchange, the class agrees to replace the multiple-choice questions with additional fill in the blank questions (any change needs to be negotiated with the class as a whole)**. Reference sheets must be handwritten; typed or printed material is not permitted.

New lecture content is introduced on exam days. Exams occur in the separate exam session, so the regular 1:00–2:50 PM lecture meets normally. Material introduced after an exam's coverage block is assessed on the next relevant exam.

Lecture Project (20% of Lecture Grade)

Each student completes one individual project on a psychological question covered in class. Choose ONE option and include your choice in your proposal. Both options are worth 120 points.

Option A: Data Analysis Project

Use data I provide or approve to answer a psychological question from class. Explain what you expected, how you analyzed the data, and what you found. Submit your analysis file, a 4–6-page APA-style report with a labeled figure, and a 5-minute recorded explanation. Use at least 4 original research articles to put your results in context, including at least 2 published from 2000 onward and at least 1 from 2020 onward. You may use a spreadsheet, jamovi, or a similar program. Advanced coding is not required. Use data with identifying information removed; do not collect new participant data.

Option B: Psychological Evidence Paper

Write a 4–6-page paper in APA 7th edition format on a psychological claim covered in class. The title page, figures, and references do not count toward the page limit. Compare at least 5 original research articles, including at least 3 published from 2000 onward and at least 1 from 2020 onward. Explain what the studies found, where they agree or disagree, and what you think the evidence supports. Propose an experiment that could help answer a remaining question. Submit a 5-minute recorded explanation with your paper. Do not simply summarize one article after another. The paper must argue something.

Project Milestones

Milestone	Due
Proposal: chosen option, focused question, initial references, and dataset if applicable (1 page)	Fri Sep 24, 11:59 PM
Progress check: argument outline or preliminary analysis, figure, and source list	Fri Oct 22, 11:59 PM
Final report, editable analysis if applicable, and recorded explanation	Fri Nov 19, 11:59 PM

Laboratory Component

The lab is a required, graded part of this course and begins in the first week. Labs meet separately from lecture. You will conduct psychological experiments, analyze data, and explain your findings in written reports.

- **Lab Reports (10 labs, lowest 2 dropped, 7.5% each for the 8 counted).** Write a short report explaining the experiment, your results, and what they mean. Include your methods, a labeled figure, and your analysis file.
- **Individual Experimental Practical (10%).** In Week 11, carry out and explain one experiment from an earlier lab. Choose one of the five topics below. You will demonstrate the procedure, analyze data, and explain your results. Instructions and practice materials will be available in advance; preparation and selection dates are in the schedule.
    - **Reaction time and the speed–accuracy trade-off:** Test how responding faster affects accuracy.
    - **Psychophysics and signal detection:** Test how people detect faint stimuli and distinguish them from noise.
    - **Selective attention and Stroop interference:** Test how conflicting word and color information affects attention.

    - **Working memory and distraction:** Test how distraction affects the amount of information people remember.
    - **Memory reconstruction and source monitoring:** Examine memory errors and how people remember where information came from.
- **Methods Assignments (3 assignments, 5% each, 15% total).** Short assignments covering data analysis, experimental design, and interpretation of research. Submit your analysis file and a written explanation or study design. Coding is optional. Due dates are listed below.
- **Mini-Replication Project (15%).** Work with your team to repeat an approved experiment from lab and compare your findings with the earlier results. Submit a plan before collecting or analyzing data, followed by a data check. Your final work includes a team poster and analysis file, your own explanation, and a team presentation in Week 15. Deadlines are listed below. This is separate from your lecture project.
- **Participation and access:** You are required to complete the work, but you do not have to provide personal data. An equivalent option is available without penalty. Use only approved tasks and data, protect classmates' privacy, and report your actual results. Do not recruit participants outside the course.

Lab Schedule and Due Dates

Lab	Week	Topic	Due / Notes
Lab 1	Week 1	Reaction time and the speed–accuracy trade-off	Report due Sun Sep 5
Lab 2	Week 2	Psychophysics: detection and response criterion	Report due Sun Sep 12
Lab 3	Week 3	Selective attention and Stroop interference	Report due Sun Sep 19
Lab 4	Week 4	Learning and reversal of action–outcome contingencies	Report due Sun Sep 26
Lab 5	Week 5	Working-memory load and distraction	Report due Sun Oct 3
Lab 6	Week 6	Memory reconstruction and source monitoring	Report due Sun Oct 17; extra time around Fall Recess
Lab 7	Week 8	Framing and risky decisions	Report due Sun Oct 24
Lab 8	Week 9	Infant cognition through looking-time data	Report due Sun Oct 31
Lab 9	Week 10	Personality measurement and the role of situations	Report due Sun Nov 7
Lab 10	Week 12	Cooperation, social norms, and group decisions	Report due Sun Nov 21; Thursday sections use an equivalent Nov 8–10 or 12
Experimental practical / project clinic	Week 11	Individual practical: choice of five familiar experiments; mini-replication proposal support	Practical in assigned lab Nov 2–4; proposal due Fri Nov 5
Project data	Week 13	Mini-replication data session and make-up support	Checkpoint due Fri Nov 19
Project presentations	Week 15	Mini-replication presentations in the assigned LAB section	Final due Fri Dec 3
Methods Assignment 1	Fri Sep 10	From responses to evidence	Due 11:59 PM
Methods Assignment 2	Fri Oct 1	Design a fair psychological experiment	Due 11:59 PM
Methods Assignment 3	Fri Oct 29	Replication, uncertainty, and generalization	Due 11:59 PM

Lab	Week	Topic	Due / Notes
Practical preparation	Tue Oct 19	All five preparation guides and practice datasets available	Prepare before Week 11
Practical topic selection	Fri Oct 22	Choose one of the five practical options	Due 11:59 PM

Lab sections meet at the times listed under Course Times & Locations; all sections meet in NEU LAB1A. All report and assignment deadlines are 11:59 PM Pacific time. No required regular lab meets in Week 7 or Week 14. Fall Recess is October 7–8, Veterans Day is November 11, and Thanksgiving is November 24–28. Holiday-affected sections receive an equivalent task without required participation on a closure day. The late work policy applies (see Late Work below).

Lecture Recordings and Study Materials

Lectures are recorded. Recordings are released **one week before the exam that covers them**. I may release them two weeks before an exam at my discretion, but early release is not guaranteed and should not be expected. You are responsible for attending lecture, taking thorough notes, and studying throughout the semester. **Do not wait for recordings to begin preparing for an exam.**

Recordings from previous offerings may also be posted as supplemental study materials. This course changes between semesters, and older recordings may omit current topics or include material that is no longer covered. **This semester's lectures determine what is examinable.** You are responsible for identifying those differences using the current lectures and slides.

Recordings do not replace attendance or excuse arriving unprepared. Lecture content is dense and requires consistent engagement. Choosing to rely on recordings does not reduce the material you are expected to know or change the standards by which your work will be graded.

Study Expectations

This course covers substantial material on a fast schedule. Plan at least two hours of outside study for every hour of class. Review each lecture within 48 hours. Practice retrieving concepts, explaining experiments, and interpreting figures rather than only rereading. Form study groups but make sure each person can answer exam questions alone. Start reports while the procedure is fresh and begin the project well before its deadline.

Lecture & Lab Attendance

Attendance at all lectures and labs is expected, but no separate attendance or participation grade is assigned. Lectures introduce explanations and examples that may appear on exams. Labs provide the instruction, experimental work, and data needed for graded assignments. If you miss a lab, contact your assigned TA promptly to arrange an approved way to complete the missed work. Contact me directly about extensions, exceptional circumstances, or grading concerns.

Late Work

- Lab reports, methods assignments, and the Mini-Replication Project: 5% deduction from the available points per calendar day late for the first 7 days. Work more than 1 week late is not accepted without an approved extension.
- **Experimental practical: This assessment takes place in person during your assigned Week 11 lab section and is not eligible for the ordinary late-submission penalty. If an emergency or approved accommodation affects your ability to attend, contact me as soon as possible to arrange an approved alternative assessment. Missing the practical without an approved arrangement results in a zero for the assessment.**
- **Lecture project:** 30% deduction for any submission after 11:59 PM on the due date. Projects submitted more than 48 hours late are not accepted.

Extensions require instructor approval. Contact me before the deadline when possible, or as soon as reasonably possible in an emergency. Approved accommodations, religious observance, and university-required arrangements take precedence over ordinary late penalties.

Academic Integrity and Use of AI Tools

Follow the university's standards of academic integrity. Cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, fabricated data or citations, and unauthorized exam materials are handled under university procedures. Generative AI may not write lab report prose, the lecture-project paper, individual mini-replication interpretations, or exam answers. Coding or software-troubleshooting assistance is permitted only when authorized and disclosed; verify all output and retain the original files. Team collection and analysis are allowed only for the specified team components. Do not upload classmates' data to external AI services.

Accommodations

Students seeking accommodations should contact the Office of Student Accessibility Services as early as possible. Provide the approved notice through the university process and coordinate lecture, lab, software, deadline, and exam arrangements with the instructor. Early notice supports planning; a course deadline does not cancel an approved accommodation. OSAS: https://osas.usc.edu/.

Communication

Questions about psychological concepts, experiments, and data analysis are expected. Use Teaching Assistants as the first point of contact for homework, lab reports, analysis, and routine logistics. TAs hold lab sessions and office hours and can provide timely support. Contact the instructor at jlopez@usc.edu for unresolved questions, grading concerns, accommodations, or confidential issues. No student is required to disclose personal mental-health experiences during class or lab.

I will make every effort to respond to emails and messages promptly; however, because I teach multiple courses and run an active research laboratory, response times may be delayed. Students should generally expect responses within one business day. Messages sent in the

evening, overnight, or on weekends will typically be addressed the following business day. Use clear subject lines that include the course number and topic, such as “PSYC100 L: Lab 3 report question.” Keep questions concise and include relevant context, such as the assignment name or lab section. Reach out early rather than waiting until deadlines or exam days. Consult the syllabus and current lecture materials for exam coverage before emailing.

Absences and Communication

I understand that many students balance academic responsibilities with work, family obligations, and other commitments. If you anticipate an absence or experience an emergency, contact me as soon as possible. For lab absences, notify your TA promptly and arrange the appropriate documentation, make-up, or equivalent task. Communicating early helps us find an appropriate arrangement.

There is no separate lecture or laboratory attendance grade. You remain responsible for missed instruction and graded work, including the experimental practical. Recordings support review but do not replace the practical skills developed in lab. Missed assignments and assessments follow their applicable policies; communicate promptly if you need an approved arrangement.

Course Calendar

Lectures meet Monday, Wednesday, and Friday, 1:00–2:50 PM. Every instructional meeting introduces a new topic, beginning August 23 and ending December 3. Exams use the separate session; planned dates are September 20, October 18, and November 8, with Exam 4 in the assigned December 8–15 appointment. Exams 1–3 meet at 5:00 PM in NEU 100A or NEU 100B; Exam 4’s assigned date and time will be announced separately. Lab weeks and deadlines appear above and below. University holidays follow USC’s Fall 2027 academic calendar (https://academics.usc.edu/calendar/).

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Assessment / Notes
Week 1	Lab 1	Reaction time and the speed–accuracy trade-off	Meets Aug 23–27; report due Sun Sep 5
Mon Aug 23	Lecture 1	Perception, illusions, and the mind’s predictions	
Wed Aug 25	Lecture 2	Experiments, causality, and psychological evidence	
Fri Aug 27	Lecture 3	Neurons, networks, and the biology of behavior	
Week 2	Lab 2	Psychophysics: detection and response criterion	Meets Aug 30–Sep 3; report due Sun Sep 12
Mon Aug 30	Lecture 4	Brain damage, plasticity, and the divided mind	
Wed Sep 1	Lecture 5	Genes, experience, and human differences	
Fri Sep 3	Lecture 6	Seeing, hearing, and detecting weak signals	
Sun Sep 5	Report due	Lab 1 report	Due 11:59 PM
Mon Sep 6	Holiday	Labor Day Holiday	No class or labs

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Assessment / Notes
Week 3	Lab 3	Selective attention and Stroop interference	Meets Sep 7–10; report due Sun Sep 19
Wed Sep 8	Lecture 7	Attention, distraction, and failures of awareness	
Fri Sep 10	Lecture 8	Consciousness, unconscious processing, and agency	Methods Assignment 1 due
Sun Sep 12	Report due	Lab 2 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 4	Lab 4	Learning and reversal of action–outcome contingencies	Meets Sep 13–17; report due Sun Sep 26
Mon Sep 13	Lecture 9	Sleep, dreaming, and biological clocks	
Wed Sep 15	Lecture 10	Drugs, reward, and addiction	
Fri Sep 17	Lecture 11	Classical conditioning: learning predictive relationships	
Sun Sep 19	Report due	Lab 3 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 5	Lab 5	Working-memory load and distraction	Meets Sep 20–24; report due Sun Oct 3
Mon Sep 20	EXAM 1	Lectures 1 to 10	Separate exam session; regular lecture also meets
Mon Sep 20	Lecture 12	Operant conditioning: actions and consequences	
Wed Sep 22	Lecture 13	Observational learning and cultural transmission	
Fri Sep 24	Lecture 14	Working memory, amnesia, and memory systems	Lecture project proposal due
Sun Sep 26	Report due	Lab 4 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 6	Lab 6	Memory reconstruction and source monitoring	Meets Sep 27–Oct 1; report due Sun Oct 17
Mon Sep 27	Lecture 15	False memories and eyewitness identification	
Wed Sep 29	Lecture 16	Retrieval, forgetting, and durable learning	
Fri Oct 1	Lecture 17	Language: acquisition, comprehension, and the brain	Methods Assignment 2 due
Sun Oct 3	Report due	Lab 5 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 7	Laboratory	Analysis support before Fall Recess	No required regular lab this week
Mon Oct 4	Lecture 18	Judgment, risk, and decision-making	
Wed Oct 6	Lecture 19	Intelligence: measurement, development, and fairness	
Fri Oct 8	Holiday	Fall Recess: October 7–8	No class or labs
Week 8	Lab 7	Framing and risky decisions	Meets Oct 11–15; report due Sun Oct 24
Mon Oct 11	Lecture 20	Motivation: hunger, goals, and self-control	
Wed Oct 13	Lecture 21	Emotion: bodily responses, appraisal, and regulation	
Fri Oct 15	Lecture 22	Stress, health, and the social environment	
Sun Oct 17	Report due	Lab 6 report	Due 11:59 PM

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Assessment / Notes
Week 9	Lab 8	Infant cognition through looking-time data	Meets Oct 18–22; report due Sun Oct 31
Mon Oct 18	EXAM 2	Lectures 11 to 20	Separate exam session; regular lecture also meets
Mon Oct 18	Lecture 23	Infant cognition and the developing mind	
Tue Oct 19	Practical preparation	Guides, prompts, and practice datasets available for all five options	At least two weeks before the first practical
Wed Oct 20	Lecture 24	Attachment, caregiving, and social development	
Fri Oct 22	Lecture 25	Adolescence: identity, peers, and risk	Lecture project progress and practical topic selection due
Sun Oct 24	Report due	Lab 7 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 10	Lab 9	Personality measurement and the role of situations	Meets Oct 25–29; report due Sun Nov 7
Mon Oct 25	Lecture 26	Adulthood, aging, and cognitive change	
Wed Oct 27	Lecture 27	Personality: traits, situations, and the self	
Fri Oct 29	Lecture 28	Sex, gender, and sexual behavior	Methods Assignment 3 due
Sun Oct 31	Report due	Lab 8 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 11	Laboratory	Individual experimental practical and mini-replication proposal support	Practical in assigned lab Nov 2–4; proposal due Fri Nov 5
Mon Nov 1	Lecture 29	Social perception, attribution, and first impressions	
Wed Nov 3	Lecture 30	Conformity, obedience, and social power	
Fri Nov 5	Lecture 31	Prejudice, discrimination, and intergroup behavior	Lab-project proposal due
Sun Nov 7	Report due	Lab 9 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 12	Lab 10	Cooperation, social norms, and group decisions	Meets Nov 8–12; report due Sun Nov 21
Mon Nov 8	EXAM 3	Lectures 21 to 30	Separate exam session; regular lecture also meets
Mon Nov 8	Lecture 32	Cooperation, helping, and collective action	
Wed Nov 10	Lecture 33	Relationships, belonging, and loneliness	
Thu Nov 11	Holiday	Veterans Day Holiday (Thursday)	No class or labs
Fri Nov 12	Lecture 34	Culture, work, and behavior in organizations	
Week 13	Laboratory	Mini-replication data session and make-up work	Checkpoint due Fri Nov 19
Mon Nov 15	Lecture 35	Psychological disorders, assessment, and neurodevelopment	

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Assessment / Notes
Wed Nov 17	Lecture 36	Anxiety, trauma, and obsessive-compulsive disorders	
Fri Nov 19	Lecture 37	Mood disorders: depression and bipolar disorder	Lecture project final and lab-project checkpoint due
Sun Nov 21	Report due	Lab 10 report	Due 11:59 PM
Week 14	Laboratory	Thanksgiving week	No required regular lab this week
Mon Nov 22	Lecture 38	Schizophrenia and psychosis	
Wed Nov 24	Holiday	Thanksgiving Holiday: November 24–28	No class or labs
Week 15	Laboratory	Mini-replication presentations in LAB sections	Final due Fri Dec 3; lectures meet normally
Mon Nov 29	Lecture 39	Dissociative, personality, and eating disorders	
Wed Dec 1	Lecture 40	Treatments: psychotherapy, medication, and prevention	
Fri Dec 3	Lecture 41	Psychology in the digital world: persuasion, misinformation, and AI	Lab-project final due
Dec 4–7	Study Days	University study period	No regular lectures or labs
Dec 8–15	EXAM 4	Lectures 31 to 41	Assigned date/time: _____

Readings Calendar

Required textbook readings for each lecture are listed below from Myers, DeWall, and Gruber, Psychology (14th ed.). Complete the listed sections before the corresponding lecture. When a chapter appears more than once, read the specified material for that day; entries marked Review ask you to revisit earlier reading. Section titles follow the textbook contents provided for this course. Lectures build on these concepts and extend into contemporary research and applications. Current lecture content defines exam coverage.

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Required Textbook Readings
Mon Aug 23	Lecture 1	Perception, illusions, and the mind’s predictions	Ch. 1: The History and Scope of Psychology. Ch. 6: Basic Concepts of Sensation and Perception; Vision: Sensory and Perceptual Processing. Focus on perceptual organization, context, and illusions.
Wed Aug 25	Lecture 2	Experiments, causality, and psychological evidence	Ch. 1: Research Strategies: How Psychologists Ask and Answer Questions; Statistical Reasoning in Everyday Life. Focus on experimental control, correlation, sampling, and interpreting evidence.
Fri Aug 27	Lecture 3	Neurons, networks, and the biology of behavior	Ch. 2: Neural and Hormonal Systems; Tools of Discovery: Having Our Head Examined; Brain Regions and Structures.
Mon Aug 30	Lecture 4	Brain damage, plasticity, and the divided mind	Ch. 2: Damage Responses and Brain Hemispheres. Review Brain Regions and Structures for the functions discussed in lecture.
Wed Sep 1	Lecture 5	Genes, experience, and human differences	Ch. 4: Behavior Genetics: Predicting Individual Differences; Evolutionary Psychology: Explaining Human Nature and Nurture. Read the nature–nurture material in Cultural and Gender Diversity.
Fri Sep 3	Lecture 6	Seeing, hearing, and detecting weak signals	Ch. 6: Basic Concepts of Sensation and Perception; Vision: Sensory and Perceptual Processing; Hearing, Skin, Chemical, and Body Senses. Focus on thresholds, signal detection, and sensory processing.
Wed Sep 8	Lecture 7	Attention, distraction, and failures of awareness	Ch. 3: Basic Consciousness Concepts. Focus on selective attention, divided attention, inattentional blindness, and change blindness.
Fri Sep 10	Lecture 8	Consciousness, unconscious processing, and agency	Ch. 3: Basic Consciousness Concepts. Focus on conscious and unconscious processing and the two-track mind; review the attention material from Lecture 7.
Mon Sep 13	Lecture 9	Sleep, dreaming, and biological clocks	Ch. 3: Sleep and Dreams.
Wed Sep 15	Lecture 10	Drugs, reward, and addiction	Ch. 3: Drugs and Consciousness. Focus on psychoactive drugs, tolerance, dependence, and addiction.
Fri Sep 17	Lecture 11	Classical conditioning: learning predictive relationships	Ch. 7: Basic Learning Concepts and Classical Conditioning.
Mon Sep 20	Lecture 12	Operant conditioning: actions and consequences	Ch. 7: Operant Conditioning.
Wed Sep 22	Lecture 13	Observational learning and cultural transmission	Ch. 7: Biology, Cognition, and Learning. Focus on observational learning and the biological and cognitive constraints on learning. Review Ch. 4’s cultural influences on behavior.
Fri Sep 24	Lecture 14	Working memory, amnesia, and memory systems	Ch. 8: Studying and Encoding Memories; Storing and Retrieving Memories. Focus on working memory, explicit and implicit memory, and amnesia.
Mon Sep 27	Lecture 15	False memories and eyewitness identification	Ch. 8: Forgetting, Memory Construction, and Improving Memory. Focus on misinformation, source errors, and eyewitness memory.

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Required Textbook Readings
Wed Sep 29	Lecture 16	Retrieval, forgetting, and durable learning	Ch. 8: Storing and Retrieving Memories; Forgetting, Memory Construction, and Improving Memory. Focus on retrieval cues, forgetting, retrieval practice, and effective study strategies.
Fri Oct 1	Lecture 17	Language: acquisition, comprehension, and the brain	Ch. 9: Language and Thought.
Mon Oct 4	Lecture 18	Judgment, risk, and decision-making	Ch. 9: Thinking. Focus on concepts, problem solving, heuristics, biases, judgment, and decision-making.
Wed Oct 6	Lecture 19	Intelligence: measurement, development, and fairness	Ch. 10: What Is Intelligence?; Intelligence Assessment and Dynamics; Genetic and Environmental Influences on Intelligence.
Mon Oct 11	Lecture 20	Motivation: hunger, goals, and self-control	Ch. 11: Basic Motivational Concepts; Hunger; Affiliation and Achievement. Focus on motivational theories, physiological regulation, goals, and achievement.
Wed Oct 13	Lecture 21	Emotion: bodily responses, appraisal, and regulation	Ch. 12: Introduction to Emotion; Expressing Emotion; Experiencing Emotion.
Fri Oct 15	Lecture 22	Stress, health, and the social environment	Ch. 12: Stress and Illness; Health and Coping.
Mon Oct 18	Lecture 23	Infant cognition and the developing mind	Ch. 5: Developmental Issues, Prenatal Development, and the Newborn; Infancy and Childhood. Focus on developmental research methods and infant perceptual and cognitive development.
Wed Oct 20	Lecture 24	Attachment, caregiving, and social development	Ch. 5: Infancy and Childhood. Focus on attachment, caregiving, temperament, and social development.
Fri Oct 22	Lecture 25	Adolescence: identity, peers, and risk	Ch. 5: Adolescence and Emerging Adulthood.
Mon Oct 25	Lecture 26	Adulthood, aging, and cognitive change	Ch. 5: Adulthood.
Wed Oct 27	Lecture 27	Personality: traits, situations, and the self	Ch. 14: Introduction to Personality and Psychodynamic Theories; Humanistic Theories and Trait Theories; Social-Cognitive Theories and the Self.
Fri Oct 29	Lecture 28	Sex, gender, and sexual behavior	Ch. 4: Cultural and Gender Diversity: Understanding Nature and Nurture. Ch. 11: Sexual Motivation.
Mon Nov 1	Lecture 29	Social perception, attribution, and first impressions	Ch. 13: Social Thinking. Focus on attribution, attitudes, and interpretations of other people’s behavior.
Wed Nov 3	Lecture 30	Conformity, obedience, and social power	Ch. 13: Social Influence. Focus on conformity, obedience, group processes, and the power of situations.
Fri Nov 5	Lecture 31	Prejudice, discrimination, and intergroup behavior	Ch. 13: Antisocial Relations. Focus on prejudice, discrimination, aggression, and intergroup conflict.
Mon Nov 8	Lecture 32	Cooperation, helping, and collective action	Ch. 13: Prosocial Relations. Focus on altruism, cooperation, conflict, and peacemaking. Review group processes in Social Influence.

Date (2027)	Session	Topic	Required Textbook Readings
Wed Nov 10	Lecture 33	Relationships, belonging, and loneliness	Ch. 11: Affiliation and Achievement, focusing on belongingness. Ch. 13: Prosocial Relations, focusing on attraction and close relationships.
Fri Nov 12	Lecture 34	Culture, work, and behavior in organizations	Ch. 4: Cultural and Gender Diversity: Understanding Nature and Nurture. Review Ch. 11: Affiliation and Achievement, focusing on achievement; and Ch. 13: Social Influence, focusing on group behavior. These sections provide the foundations for the lecture's applications to work and organizations.
Mon Nov 15	Lecture 35	Psychological disorders, assessment, and neurodevelopment	Ch. 15: Introduction to Psychological Disorders; Neurodevelopmental Disorders. Focus on classification, assessment, explanatory models, and developmental context.
Wed Nov 17	Lecture 36	Anxiety, trauma, and obsessive-compulsive disorders	Ch. 15: Anxiety Disorders, Obsessive Compulsive and Related Disorders, Trauma- and Stressor-Related Disorders, and Somatic Symptom and Related Disorders.
Fri Nov 19	Lecture 37	Mood disorders: depression and bipolar disorder	Ch. 15: Depressive Disorders and Bipolar Disorders.
Mon Nov 22	Lecture 38	Schizophrenia and psychosis	Ch. 15: Schizophrenia.
Mon Nov 29	Lecture 39	Dissociative, personality, and eating disorders	Ch. 15: Dissociative, Personality, and Eating Disorders.
Wed Dec 1	Lecture 40	Treatments: psychotherapy, medication, and prevention	Ch. 16: Introduction to Therapy and the Psychological Therapies; Evaluating Psychotherapies; The Biomedical Therapies and Preventing Psychological Disorders.
Fri Dec 3	Lecture 41	Psychology in the digital world: persuasion, misinformation, and AI	Review Ch. 9: Thinking, focusing on judgment and belief; Ch. 13: Social Thinking and Social Influence, focusing on attitudes and persuasion; and Ch. 1: Research Strategies: How Psychologists Ask and Answer Questions. These sections provide the foundations for the lecture's applications to digital media, misinformation, and AI.

Final Word

This course asks you to think like a psychological scientist: explain a behavior, examine the experiment, and decide what the evidence supports. If you show up to lecture and lab, review the material regularly, and start early, you will leave with a working understanding of how people perceive, learn, remember, develop, and interact. Be prepared to question an explanation, work carefully with data, and revise a conclusion when the evidence changes.

Banner: Tractography of the optic radiation, by Maxime Chamberland, Chantal M. W. Tax, and Derek K. Jones, CC BY 4.0. Source: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tractography_of_the_optic_radiation.png. License: https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/.